



D&C 137-138



1836

1918

Sec 137

Sec 138

SLC, UT

Sec. 138

Sections Received:

Before 1831

1831-1839

1840-1844

Since 1844

Sec. 136

Sec. 41, 42, 43, 44, 45, 46, 47,
48, 49, 50, 52, 53, 54, 55, 56,
63, 64, 70, 72, 78, 84, 85, 86,
87, 88, 89, 90, 91, 92, 93, 94,
95, 96, 97, 98, 101, 102, 103,
104, 106, 107, 108, 109, 110,
112, 134, 137

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21, 28, 29, 30,
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35, 36, 37, 38,
39, 40

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10, 11, 12, 13, 24, 25,
26, 27

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Nauvoo
Remus

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Far West

Liberty

61

62

Sec. 105

Sec. 57, 58,
59, 60, 82, 83

Jackson County

Places Where the Sections of the Doctrine and Covenants Were Revealed

NEW YORK

Salem, MA

Palmyra
Manchester
Fayette

Perrysburg

Harmony

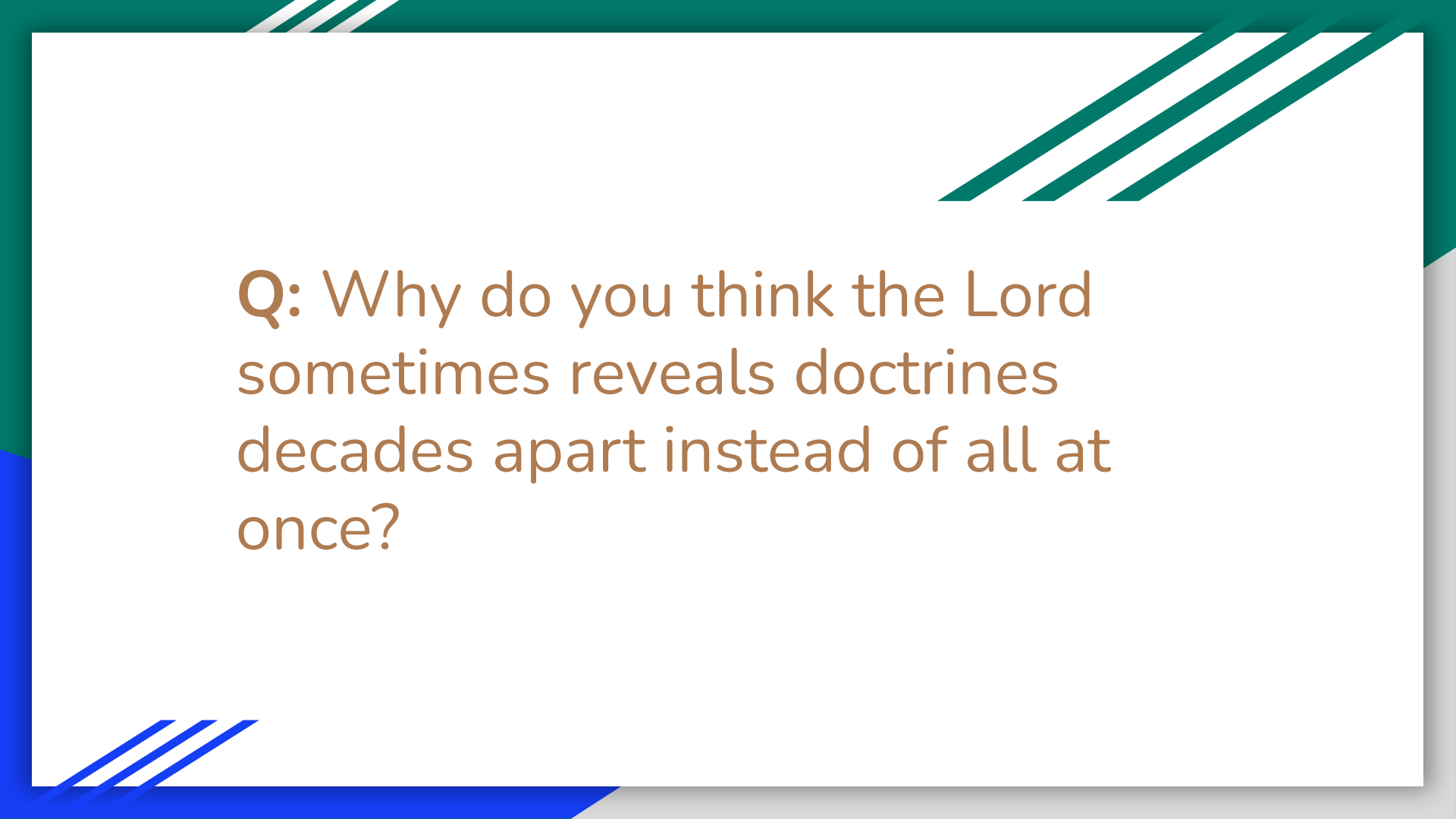
Thompson

Kirtland

Hiram

Amherst

PENNSYLVANIA



Q: Why do you think the Lord sometimes reveals doctrines decades apart instead of all at once?

**Doctrine
Covenants & 137**





“On the afternoon of 21 January 1836, [Joseph Smith] and the church presidency met in the council room above the printing office to take another step in preparation for the endowment. Following biblical precedent, these church leaders washed their bodies with water and perfumed themselves with a sweet-smelling wash.” That evening Joseph Smith, his Counselors in the First Presidency, and other Church leaders gathered in an upper room of the nearly finished Kirtland Temple. “According to Oliver Cowdery, the members of the church presidency were ‘annointed with the same kind of oil and in the man[ner] that were Moses and Aaron, and those who stood before the Lord in ancient days’ [see Exodus 40:9–15]. The presidency first anointed church patriarch Joseph Smith Sr.’s head with consecrated oil and gave him a blessing. The patriarch then anointed the church’s presidents in the order of their ages. When Joseph Smith Sr. anointed the head of [Joseph Smith], he ‘sealed upon [him], the blessings, of Moses, to lead Israel in the latter days.’



Q: Have you ever had a moment
when preparing spiritually made you
more open to inspiration?

Q: What did you notice?



“All things whatsoever God in his infinite wisdom has seen fit and proper to reveal to us, while we are dwelling in mortality, in regard to our mortal bodies, are revealed to us in the abstract, and independent of affinity of [connection to] this mortal tabernacle, but **are revealed to our spirits** precisely as though we had no bodies at all”

(*Teachings of Presidents of the Church: Joseph Smith* [2007], 475).

Ohio, January 21, 1836. The occasions in preparation for the dedicat

1–6, The Prophet sees his brother Alvin in the celestial kingdom; 7–9, The doctrine of salvation for the dead is revealed; 10, All children are saved in the celestial kingdom.

THE ^aheavens were ^bopened upon us, and I beheld the ^ccelestial kingdom of God, and the glory thereof, whether in the ^abody or out I cannot tell.

36b Rev. 19:2;
Morm. 8:41 (40–41).

37a TG Purity.
b Hel. 8:18 (16–19).

c Rev. 14:6;
D&C 27:16; 110:11, 16.

41a TG Jesus
of the C

b Dan. 7:

42a TG Stea

137 1a Acts 7:5
1 No. 1

ON 137

*Prophet, in the temple at Kirtland,
ion was the administration of ordi-
tion of the temple.*

2 I saw the transcendent ^abeauty of the ^bgate through which the heirs of that kingdom will enter, which was ^clike unto ^dcircling flames of fire;

3 Also the ^ablazing ^bthrone of God, whereon was seated the ^cFather and the ^dSon.

4 I saw the beautiful streets of that kingdom, which had the appearance of being paved with ^agold.

5 I saw Father ^aAdam and ^bAbraham;

and my ^cfather and my mother; my brother ^dAlvin, that has long since ^eslept;

6 And ^amarveled how it was that he had obtained an ^binheritance in that kingdom, seeing that he had departed this life before the Lord had set his hand to ^cgather Israel the second time, and had not been ^dbaptized for the remission of sins.

7 Thus came the ^avoice of the Lord unto me, saying: All who have died ^bwithout a knowledge of this gospel, who would have received it if they had been permitted to tarry,



Church History in the Fullness of Times

Joseph Smith loved and admired his eldest brother, Alvin. Alvin loved Joseph too, and he supported Joseph in his preparation to receive the gold plates from the angel Moroni. In November 1823, when Alvin was 25 years old and Joseph was 17, Alvin suddenly became gravely ill. As his condition worsened and it became apparent that he would soon die, he counseled Joseph: “I want you to be a good boy and do everything that lies in your power to obtain the records. Be faithful in receiving instruction and keeping every commandment that is given you”

(Church History in the Fulness of Times Student Manual, 41–42).



Teachings of Presidents of the Church: Joseph Smith

Alvin's death brought great sorrow to the Smith family. A Presbyterian minister in Palmyra, New York, officiated at Alvin's funeral. "As Alvin had not been a member of the minister's congregation, the clergyman asserted in his sermon that Alvin could not be saved. William Smith, Joseph's younger brother, recalled: '[The minister] ... intimated very strongly that [Alvin] had gone to hell, for Alvin was not a church member, but he was a good boy and my father did not like it'"

(p. 401, 403).



Q: How would you feel in Joseph's place—seeing loved ones in the celestial kingdom, even if they hadn't received certain ordinances yet?



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my brother ^dAlvin, that has long
since ^eslept;

6 And ^amarveled how it was that
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that kingdom, seeing that he had
departed this life before the Lord
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the second time, and had not been
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7 Thus came the ^avoice of the Lord
unto me, saying: All who have died
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pel, who would have received it if
they had been permitted to tarry,

shall be ^cheirs of the celestial king-
dom of God;

8 Also all that shall die hence-
forth without a knowledge of it,
who ^awould have received it with
all their hearts, shall be heirs of
that kingdom;

9 For I, the Lord, will ^ajudge all
men according to their ^bworks, ac-
cording to the ^cdesire of their hearts.

10 And I also beheld that all ^achil-
dren who die before they arrive
at the ^byears of accountability are
^csaved in the celestial kingdom of
heaven.

SECTION 138

“The desires of our hearts will be an important consideration in the final judgment. Alma taught that God ‘granteth unto men according to their desire, whether it be unto death or unto life; ... according to their wills, whether they be unto salvation or unto destruction. Yea, ... he that knoweth good and evil, to him it is given according to his desires.’ (Alma 29:4–5.)

“That is a sobering teaching, but it is also a gratifying one. It means that when we have done all that we can, our desires will carry us the rest of the way. It also means that if our desires are right, we can be forgiven for the mistakes we will inevitably make as we try to carry those desires into effect. What a comfort for our feelings of inadequacy! ...

“... We should not assume that the desires of our hearts can serve as a substitute for an ordinance of the gospel...



Q: What does “the desire of their hearts” really mean?

Q: How does this doctrine change the way you see people of other faiths—or no faith?



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8 Also all that shall die henceforth without a knowledge of it, who ^awould have received it with all their hearts, shall be heirs of that kingdom;

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ON 138

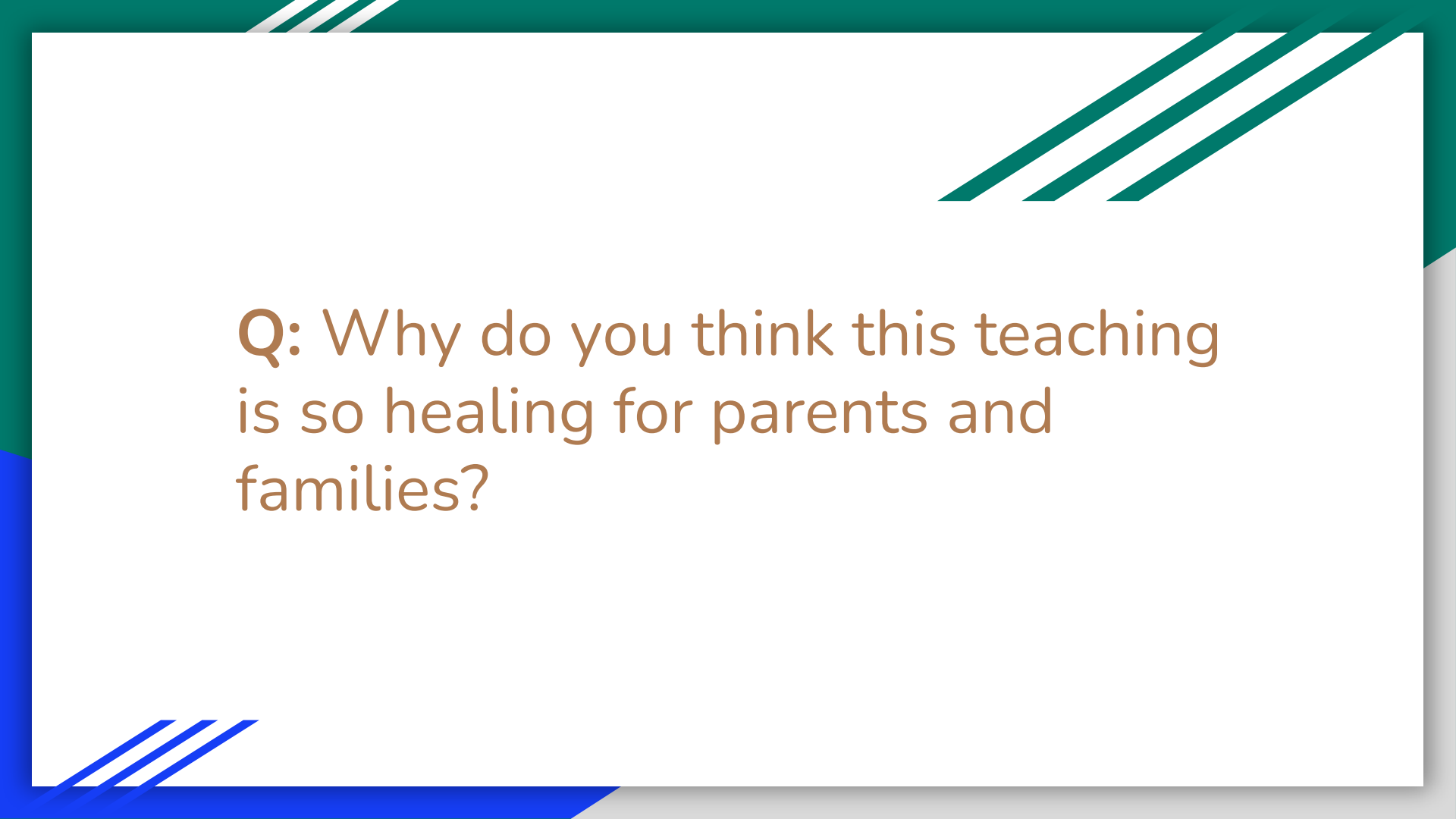
F. Smith in Salt Lake City, Utah,

“There is only one source of true peace. I am certain that the Lord, who notes the fall of a sparrow, looks with compassion upon those who have been called upon to part—even temporarily—from their precious children. The gifts of healing and of peace are desperately needed, and Jesus, through His Atonement, has provided them for one and all.

“The Prophet Joseph Smith spoke inspired words of revelation and comfort:

“‘All children who die before they arrive at the years of accountability are saved in the celestial kingdom of heaven’ [D&C 137:10].

Oct 1998 GC, Ensign, Nov. 1998, 20).



Q: Why do you think this teaching is so healing for parents and families?

**Doctrine
Covenants & 138**





Ten days after the conference, President Smith dictated his vision of the spirit world to his son Joseph Fielding Smith, who was then a member of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles. President Smith's counselors in the First Presidency, the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles, and the Patriarch to the Church approved the vision as revelation on October 31, 1918. (See Tait, "Susa Young Gates," 319; D&C 138, section heading.) **The written account of the vision was added to the Pearl of Great Price in 1976. In 1979 the First Presidency and Quorum of the Twelve Apostles announced that the vision would be added to the Doctrine and Covenants as section 138 in the 1981 edition of the scriptures (see "Additions to D&C Approved," Church News, June 2, 1979, 3).**

Joseph F. Smith's Vision (D&C 138)

- **Date of Vision:** October 3, 1918
- **Context:**
 - Joseph F. Smith had experienced **loss from a young age**: father (1844, age 5), mother (1852, age 13).
 - Continued losses later: several children, other family members.
 - 1918 was especially hard:
 - Eldest son Hiram Max Smith died (Jan),
 - Son-in-law died (Feb),
 - Daughter-in-law Ida died (Sep).
 - **World events:** WWI and influenza pandemic.
 - His **own health** was poor.
- **Spiritual Preparation:**
 - Personal grief can lead to **deep spiritual insight**.
 - Continuous prayer and pondering prepare the heart for revelation.
 - Spent months in **prayer, supplication, and reflection** on the dead.
 - Communed continuously with the Spirit of the Lord.
- **General Conference:**
 - The day after his vision, he spoke in October 1918 conference:
 - "I will not... attempt to enter upon many things that are resting upon my mind... I have not lived alone these five months."
 - Vision provides doctrine on **redemption of the dead**.
- **Documentation & Approval:**
 - God's timing and approval: vision shared gradually, later canonized.
 - 10 days later: dictated vision to **Joseph Fielding Smith**.
 - Approved by **First Presidency, Quorum of the Twelve, and Church Patriarch** (Oct 31, 1918).
- **Canonical Status:**
 - Added to **Pearl of Great Price**: 1976
 - Announced to be added to **D&C Section 138**: 1979
 - Included in **1981 LDS Edition of the Scriptures**



Q: How do personal experiences
with loss or hardship make us
seek revelation differently?



The idea that scripture reading can lead to inspiration and revelation opens the door to the truth that a scripture is not limited to what it meant when it was written. Elder Bruce R. McConkie said, "I sometimes think that one of the best-kept secrets of the kingdom is that the scriptures open the door to the receipt of revelation" (Doctrines of the Restoration, ed. Mark L. McConkie, Salt Lake City: Bookcraft, 1989, p. 243). This happens because scripture reading puts us in tune with the Spirit of the Lord. To assist each of us to receive personal revelation.

(Elder Dallin H. Oaks, "Scripture Reading and Revelation," Ensign, January, 1995)

sat in my room ^apondering over the scriptures;

2 And ^areflecting upon the great ^batonement ^csacrifice that was made by the Son of God, for the ^dredemption of the world;

3 And the great and wonderful ^alove made manifest by the Father and the Son in the coming of the ^bRedeemer into the world;

4 That through his ^aatonement, and by ^bobedience to the principles of the gospel, mankind might be saved.

5 While I was thus engaged, my mind reverted to the writings of the apostle Peter, to the ^aprimitive saints scattered abroad throughout ^bPontus, Galatia, Cappadocia, and other parts of Asia, where the gospel had been ^cpreached after the crucifixion of the Lord.



“It is a good thing sometimes to read a book of scripture within a set period of time to get an overall sense of its message, but for conversion, you should care more about the amount of time you spend in the scriptures than about the amount you read in that time. I see you sometimes reading a few verses, stopping to ponder them, carefully reading the verses again, and as you think about what they mean, praying for understanding, asking questions in your mind, waiting for spiritual impressions, and writing down the impressions and insights that come so you can remember and learn more. Studying in this way, you may not read a lot of chapters or verses in a half hour, but you will be giving place in your heart for the word of God, and He will be speaking to you”

(Elder D. Todd Christofferson, “When Thou Art Converted,” Apr 2004 GC, Ensign or Liahona, May 2004, 11).



Q: What helps you actually “ponder” rather than just read?

Q: Can you think of a time scripture study brought insight that wasn't directly about the verses you read?



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of God waited in the days of Noah, while the ark was a preparing, wherein few, that is, eight souls were saved by water." (1 Peter 3:18–20.)

10 "For for this cause was the gospel preached also to them that are dead, that they might be judged according to men in the flesh, but live according to God in the spirit." (1 Peter 4:6.)

11 As I ^apondered over these things which are ^bwritten, the ^ceyes of my ^dunderstanding were opened, and the Spirit of the Lord ^erested upon me, and I saw the hosts of the ^fdead, both small and great.

12 And there were gathered together in one place an innumerable company of the spirits of the ^ajust, who had been ^bfaithful in the ^ctestimony of Jesus while they lived in

“Some gifts coming from the Atonement [of Jesus Christ] are universal, infinite, and unconditional. These include His ransom for Adam’s original transgression ... [see Articles of Faith 1:2]. Another universal gift is the Resurrection from the dead of every man, woman, and child who lives, has ever lived, or ever will live on earth.

“Other aspects of Christ’s atoning gift are conditional. They depend on one’s diligence in keeping God’s commandments. For example, while all members of the human family are freely given a reprieve from Adam’s sin through no effort of their own, they are not given a reprieve from their own sins unless they pledge faith in Christ, repent of those sins, are baptized in His name, receive the gift of the Holy Ghost and confirmation into Christ’s Church, and press forward in faithful endurance the remainder of life’s journey. ...

have the opportunity to receive the fullness of the gospel after death, in the spirit world, where spirits reside while awaiting the Resurrection [see Alma 40:11; D&C 138; compare Luke 23:43; John 5:25]”

(Elder Jeffrey R. Holland, “The Atonement of Jesus Christ,” Ensign, Mar. 2008, 35–37).

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^bRedeemer into the world;

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saints scattered abroad throughout
^bPontus, Galatia, Cappadocia, and
other parts of Asia, where the gos-
pel had been ^cpreached after the
crucifixion of the Lord.

6 I opened the Bible and read the
^athird and fourth chapters of the
first epistle of Peter, and as I read I
was greatly ^bimpressed, more than
I had ever been before, with the
following passages:

7 "For Christ also hath once suf-
fered for sins, the just for the un-
just, that he might bring us to God,
being put to death in the flesh, but
quickened by the Spirit:

8 "By which also he went and
preached unto the spirits in ^aprison;

9 "Which sometime were disobe-
dient, when once the longsuffering

live according to God in the spirit.
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company of the spirits of the ^ajust,
who had been ^bfaithful in the ^ctes-
timony of Jesus while they lived in
mortality;

13 And who had offered ^asacrifice
in the ^bsimilitude of the great sac-
rifice of the Son of God, and had
suffered ^ctribulation in their Re-
deemer's ^aname.

14 All these had departed the
mortal life, firm in the ^ahope of a
glorious ^bresurrection, through the
^cgrace of God the ^dFather and his
^eOnly Begotten Son, Jesus Christ.

15 I beheld that they were filled
with ^ajoy and gladness, and were
rejoicing together because the day
of their ^bdeliverance was at hand.



Q: Why is having a physical body
so important to our eternal
happiness?



D&C 93:33–34

33 For man is spirit. The elements are eternal, and spirit and element, inseparably connected, receive a fulness of joy;

34 And when separated, man cannot receive a fulness of joy.

16 They were assembled awaiting the advent of the Son of God into the ^aspirit world, to declare their ^bredemption from the ^cbands of death.

17 Their sleeping ^adust was to be ^brestored unto its ^cperfect frame, ^abone to his bone, and the sinews and the flesh upon them, the ^espirit and the body to be united never again to be divided, that they might receive a fulness of ^fjoy.

18 While this vast multitude waited and conversed, rejoicing in the hour of their ^adeliverance from the chains of death, the Son of God appeared, declaring ^bliberty to the ^ccaptives who had been faithful;

19 And there he ^apreached to them the everlasting ^bgospel, the doctrine of the ^cresurrection and the redemption of mankind from the ^dfall, and from individual sins on conditions of ^erepentance.

20 But unto the ^awicked he did not go, and among the ungodly and the unrepentant who had ^bdefiled themselves while in the flesh, his

23 And ^aredemption and acknowledgment as their from de

24 The ^brad the Lord ^csang pr

25 I m that the years in Jews and endeavor lasting repenta

26 And mighty proclaim ^apower but ^bfe voice, and rece

27 But who we ^abrief ti crucifix 28 And

“Before Christ bridged the gulf between paradise and hell—so that the righteous could mingle with the wicked and preach them the gospel—the wicked in hell were confined to locations which precluded them from contact with the righteous in paradise. ...

“Now that the righteous spirits in paradise have been commissioned to carry the message of salvation to the wicked spirits in hell, there is a certain amount of mingling together of the good and bad spirits. Repentance opens the prison doors to the spirits in hell; it enables those bound with the chains of hell to free themselves from darkness, unbelief, ignorance, and sin. As rapidly as they can overcome these obstacles—gain light, believe truth, acquire intelligence, cast off sin, and break the chains of hell—they can leave the hell that imprisons them and dwell with the righteous in the peace of paradise”

(Elder Bruce R. McConkie, “Mormon Doctrine,” 2nd ed. [1966], 755).

receive a fulness of joy

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20 But unto the ^awicked he did not go, and among the ungodly and the unrepentant who had ^bdefiled themselves while in the flesh, his voice was not raised;

21 Neither did the ^arebellious who rejected the ^btestimonies and the warnings of the ancient ^cprophets behold his ^dpresence, nor look upon his face.

22 Where these were, ^adarkness reigned, but among the righteous there was ^bpeace;



Q: Why do you think Christ didn't personally go to the wicked spirits?

Q: How does this teach us that God's plan is both fair and merciful?



16 They were assembled awaiting the advent of the Son of God into the ^aspirit world, to declare their ^bredemption from the ^cbands of death.

17 Their sleeping ^adust was to be ^brestored unto its ^cperfect frame, ^dbone to his bone, and the sinews and the flesh upon them, the ^espirit and the body to be united never again to be divided, that they might receive a fulness of ^fjoy.

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23 And the saints rejoiced in their ^aredemption, and bowed the ^bknee and acknowledged the Son of God as their Redeemer and Deliverer from death and the ^cchains of ^dhell.

24 Their countenances ^ashone, and the ^bradiance from the presence of the Lord rested upon them, and they ^csang praises unto his holy name.

25 I marveled, for I understood that the Savior spent about three years in his ^aministry among the Jews and those of the house of Israel, endeavoring to ^bteach them the everlasting gospel and call them unto repentance;

26 And yet, notwithstanding his mighty works, and miracles, and proclamation of the truth, in great ^apower and authority, there were but ^bfew who hearkened to his voice, and rejoiced in his presence, and received salvation at his hands.

27 But his ministry among those who were dead was limited to the ^abrief time intervening between the crucifixion and his resurrection:

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27 But his ministry among those who were dead was limited to the ^abrief time intervening between the crucifixion and his resurrection;

28 And I wondered at the words of Peter—wherein he said that the Son of God preached unto the ^aspirits in prison, who sometime were disobedient, when once the long-suffering of God waited in the days of Noah—and how it was possible for him to preach to those spirits and perform the necessary labor among them in so short a time.

29 And as I wondered, my eyes were opened, and my understanding ^aquickened, and I perceived that the Lord went not in person among the ^bwicked and the disobedient who had rejected the truth, to teach them;

30 But behold, from among the righteous, he ^aorganized his forces and appointed ^bmessengers, ^cclothed with power and authority, and ^dcommissioned them to go forth and carry the light of the gospel to them that were in ^edarkness, even to ^fall the spirits of men; and thus was the gospel preached to the dead.

31 And the chosen messengers went forth to declare the ^aacceptable day of the Lord and proclaim ^bliberty to the captives who were bound, even unto all who would ^crepent of their sins and receive the gospel.

32 Thus was the gospel preached to those who had ^adied in their sins, without a ^bknowledge of the truth, or in ^ctransgression, having ^drejected the prophets.

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32 Thus was the gospel preached to those who had ^adied in their sins, without a ^bknowledge of the truth, or in ^ctransgression, having ^drejected the prophets.

33 These were taught ^afaith in God, repentance from sin, ^bvicarious baptism for the ^cremission of sins, the ^dgift of the Holy Ghost by the laying on of hands,

34 And all other principles of the gospel that were necessary for them to know in order to qualify themselves that they might be ^ajudged

according to men in the flesh, but live according to God in the spirit.

35 And so it was made known among the dead, both small and great, the unrighteous as well as the faithful, that redemption had been wrought through the ^asacrifice of the Son of God upon the ^bcross.

36 Thus was it made known that our Redeemer spent his time during his sojourn in the world of ^aspirits, instructing and preparing the faithful spirits of the ^bprophets who had testified of him in the flesh;

37 That they might carry the message of redemption unto all the dead, unto whom he could not go personally, because of their ^arebellion and transgression, that they through the ministration of his servants might also hear his words.

38 Among the great and ^amighty ones who were assembled in this vast congregation of the righteous were Father ^bAdam, the ^cAncient of Days and father of all,

39 And our glorious ^aMother ^bEve, with many of her faithful ^cdaughters who had lived through the ages and worshiped the true and living God.

40 ^aAbel, the first ^bmartyr, was there, and his brother ^cSeth, one of the mighty ones, who was in the express ^dimage of his father, Adam.

41 ^aNoah, who gave warning of the

...ant, who declared by
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d the opening of the
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...r, Ezekiel, who was
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who foresaw and fore-
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...In these and many more, even
the ^aprophets who dwelt among the
Nephites and ^btestified of the com-
ing of the Son of God, mingled in
the vast assembly and waited for
their deliverance,

50 For the ^adead had looked upon
the long absence of their ^bspirits
from their bodies as a ^cbondage.

51 These the Lord taught, and gave
them ^apower to come forth, after his
resurrection from the dead, to enter
into his Father's kingdom, there to
be crowned with ^bimmortality and
eternal life,

52 And continue thenceforth their
labor as had been promised by the
Lord, and be partakers of all ^abless-
ings which were held in reserve for
them that love him

53 The Prophet Joseph Smith, and
my father, Hyrum Smith, Brigham
Young, John Taylor, Wilford Wood-
ruff, and other choice ^aspirits who
were ^breserved to come forth in
the ^cfulness of times to take part
in laying the ^afoundations of the
great latter-day work,

54 Including the building of the
^atemples and the performance of
ordinances therein for the redemp-
tion of the ^bdead, were also in the
spirit world.

55 I observed that they were also

among the ^anoble and great ones
who were ^bchosen in the beginning
to be rulers in the Church of God.

56 Even before they were born,
they, with many others, received
their first ^alessons in the world of
spirits and were ^bprepared to come
forth in the due ^ctime of the Lord
to labor in his ^avineyard for the sal-
vation of the souls of men.

57 I beheld that the faithful elders
of this dispensation, when they de-
part from mortal life, continue their
labors in the ^bpreaching of the ^cgos-
pel of repentance and redemption,
through the sacrifice of the Only
Begotten Son of God, among those

who are in darkne
bondage of sin in
of the ^aspirits of th

58 The dead who
redeemed, through
^bordinances of the

59 And after the
^apenalty of their tra
are ^bwashed clean
^creward according

for they are heirs
60 Thus was the ^c
demption of the c
me, and I bear rec
that this ^brecord i
the blessing of our
Jesus Christ, even

55a Abr. 3:22 (22–24).

b TG Foreordination.

56a TG Earth, Purpose of;
Learn.

b Job 38:7 (1–7);
Alma 13:3 (3–7).

c Acts 17:26.

d Jacob 6:2 (2–3).

57a TG Elder, Melchizedek
Priesthood;

Missionary Work.

b TG Mission of
Latter-day Saints.

c TG Gospel.

d TG Spirits in Prison.

58a TG Redemption;

Repent.

b Matt. 16:19.

TG Covenants;
Ordinance.

59a TG

b AL

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60a Re

b TG

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OFFICIAL DECLARATION 1

The Bible and the Book of Mormon teach that monogamy is the only lawful marriage.



“Your spirit is an eternal entity. ...

“Your Heavenly Father has known you for a very long time. You, as His son or daughter, were chosen by Him to come to earth at this precise time, to be a leader in His great work on earth [See Alma 13:2–3; D&C 138:38–57]. You were chosen not for your bodily characteristics but for your spiritual attributes, such as bravery, courage, integrity of heart, a thirst for truth, a hunger for wisdom, and a desire to serve others.

“You developed some of these attributes premortally. Others you can develop here on earth as you persistently seek them [see 1 Corinthians 12; 14:1–12; Moroni 10:8–19; D&C 46:10–29]”

(President Russell M. Nelson, “Decisions for Eternity,” Oct 2013 GC, Ensign or Liahona, Nov. 2013, 107).

among the ^anoble and great ones who were ^bchosen in the beginning to be rulers in the Church of God.

56 Even before they were born, they, with many others, received their first ^alessons in the world of spirits and were ^bprepared to come forth in the due ^ctime of the Lord to labor in his ^dvineyard for the salvation of the souls of men.

57 I beheld that the faithful ^aelders of this dispensation, when they depart from mortal life, continue their labors in the ^bpreaching of the ^cgospel of repentance and redemption, through the sacrifice of the Only Begotten Son of God, among those

who are in darkness and under the bondage of sin in the great world of the ^dspirits of the dead.

58 The dead who ^arepent will be redeemed, through obedience to the ^bordinances of the house of God,

59 And after they have paid the ^apenalty of their transgressions, and are ^bwashed clean, shall receive a ^creward according to their ^dworks, for they are heirs of salvation.

60 Thus was the ^avision of the redemption of the dead revealed to me, and I bear record, and I know that this ^brecord is ^ctrue, through the blessing of our Lord and Savior, Jesus Christ, even so. Amen.

55a Abr. 3:22 (22–24).

b TG Foreordination.

56a TG Earth, Purpose of;
Learn.

b Job 38:7 (1–7);
Alma 13:3 (3–7).

c Acts 17:26.

Missionary Work.

b TG Mission of
Latter-day Saints.

c TG Gospel.

d TG Spirits in Prison.

58a TG Redemption;
Repent.

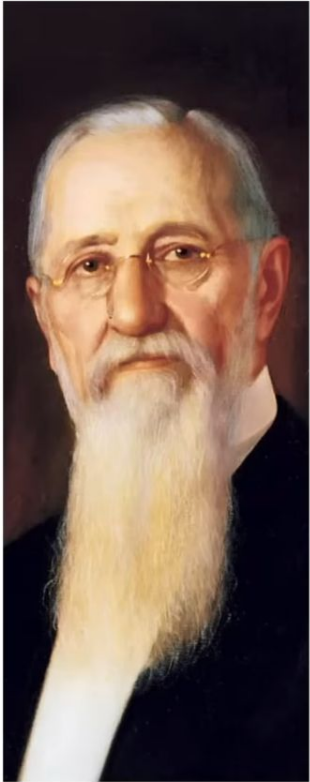
59a TG Punish.

b Alma 5:21 (17–22).
TG Forgive.

c TG Justice;
Reward.

d TG Good Works.

60a Rev. 20:12.



“Now, among all these millions of spirits that have lived on the earth and have passed away, from generation to generation, since the beginning of the world, without the knowledge of the gospel—among them you may count that at least one-half are women. Who is going to preach the gospel to the women? Who is going to carry the testimony of Jesus Christ to the hearts of the women who have passed away without a knowledge of the gospel? Well, to my mind, it is a simple thing. These good sisters who have been set apart, ordained to the work, called to it, authorized by the authority of the holy Priesthood to minister for their sex, in the House of God for the living and for the dead, will be fully authorized and empowered to preach the gospel and minister to the women”

(President Joseph F. Smith, “Gospel Doctrine,” 5th ed. [1939], 461).

among the ^anoble and great ones who were ^bchosen in the beginning to be rulers in the Church of God.

56 Even before they were born, they, with many others, received their first ^alessons in the world of spirits and were ^bprepared to come forth in the due ^ctime of the Lord to labor in his ^dvineyard for the salvation of the souls of men.

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56a TG Earth, Purpose of;
Learn.

b Job 38:7 (1–7);
Alma 13:3 (3–7).

c Acts 17:26.

Missionary Work.

b TG Mission of
Latter-day Saints.

c TG Gospel.

d TG Spirits in Prison.

58a TG Redemption;
Repent.

59a TG Punish.

b Alma 5:21 (17–22).
TG Forgive.

c TG Justice;
Reward.

d TG Good Works.

60a Rev. 20:12.

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who are in darkness and under the
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redeemed, through obedience to the
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demption of the dead revealed to
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missionary Work.
Mission of
Every-day Saints.
Gospel.
Spirits in Prison.
Redemption;
ent.
t. 16:19.

59a TG Punish.
b Alma 5:21 (17-22).
TG Forgive.
c TG Justice;
Reward.
d TG Good Works.
60a Rev. 20:12.
b TG Testimony.

“I believe, strongly too, that when the
Gospel is preached to the spirits in
prison, the success attending that
preaching will be far greater than that
attending the preaching of our Elders in
this life. I believe there will be very few
indeed of those spirits who will not
gladly receive the Gospel when it is
carried to them. The circumstances
there will be a thousand times more
favorable”

*(“Discourse by President Lorenzo Snow,” The
Latter-day Saints’ Millennial Star, Jan. 22, 1894,
50).*



Q: How does this change your view
of temple work?

Q: What does this reveal about God's
love for every person who has ever
lived?





Wrap-Up: Key Doctrines from D&C 137–138

D&C 137:9	God judges by desire + action.
D&C 138:1–2	Scripture study invites revelation.
D&C 138:57–59	Salvation extends to the dead.
D&C 137:10	Children who die young are saved.
D&C 93:33–34	Resurrection brings a fulness of joy.
D&C 138:30–34	Christ directs work on both sides of the veil.

